

Meridian University Central Library

Research Services Guide 2025

Research Consultation Service

The library offers one-on-one research consultations with subject librarians. Students can book a 30-minute slot via the library portal under Research Services. Consultations cover topic selection, database searching, citation management, and literature review strategies. Faculty members can book extended 60-minute sessions.

Using IEEE Xplore for Engineering Research

IEEE Xplore contains over 5 million technical documents including journals, conference papers, and standards. To search effectively: use Boolean operators (AND, OR, NOT), filter by year range, select document type (journal vs conference), and use the Command Search for advanced queries. Access requires being on-campus or using the university VPN.

ScienceDirect for Science and Medical Research

ScienceDirect hosts over 18 million articles from Elsevier journals. Key subject areas include Physics, Chemistry, Computer Science, Medicine, and Engineering. Full-text PDF access is included in the university subscription. Use the Saved Search feature to get email alerts for new publications matching your topic.

Citation Management with Zotero

The library recommends Zotero for citation management. It is free, open-source, and integrates with Microsoft Word and Google Docs. A library workshop on Zotero is held every first Friday of the month at 3:00 PM in Study Room 2B. Zotero can automatically import citations from IEEE Xplore, ScienceDirect, and most other academic databases.

Plagiarism and Academic Integrity

The library provides free access to Turnitin for plagiarism checking via the student portal. Students are allowed up to 3 Turnitin submissions per assignment. All submitted work must be original. The university Academic Integrity Policy is available at the Help Desk and online. Violations may result in academic penalties as per the university regulations.

Open Access Resources

The library encourages use of Open Access resources. Key free databases include: PubMed Central for biomedical research, arXiv for physics and computer science preprints, DOAJ (Directory of Open Access Journals), Google Scholar for general academic search, and OpenDOAR for institutional repositories worldwide.